

KIERA VARELA

San Antonio, TX (open to relocating to Austin) | kieravarela@yahoo.com | linkedin.com/in/kiera-varela-4b8623320

SUMMARY

Cybersecurity student (BAT, December 2026) with hands-on service desk, SOC and infrastructure experience. Resolve user tickets in Jira, manage Active Directory access, write Confluence knowledge-base guides and investigate alerts in Cisco XDR. Ranked in the 98th percentile nationally in the National Cyber League; earning CompTIA Security+ (exam November 2026).

SKILLS

Service Desk & Collaboration: Jira, Confluence, Zoom, Slack, Microsoft Office, customer support, technical documentation

Identity & Access: Active Directory, Okta (MFA)

Infrastructure: VMware vSphere/vCenter, Proxmox VE, Dell PowerStore (NAS, SMB), rack-and-stack hardware installation, Kubernetes, GitLab, Windows, Linux, PowerShell

Networking: DNS, DHCP, TCP/IP, VPN (NetBird), RDP, BGP, Cisco routers and switches

Security & AI: Cisco XDR, Cisco Secure Endpoint, Dell CAVA, Nmap, Kali Linux; AI tools for troubleshooting and system configuration

EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Intern, Campus SOC

Aug 2024 – Present

Red Knight / St. Philip's College, San Antonio, TX

- Troubleshoot and resolve user issues with access, accounts, passwords, VPN, RDP, endpoints and virtual machines; document and track every request in Jira
- Manage user accounts, permissions and access rights in Active Directory
- Investigate security alerts using Cisco XDR and Cisco Secure Endpoint; work with Cisco networking equipment to resolve issues
- Write step-by-step Confluence guides, such as NetBird VPN account setup, so users can resolve common issues on their own
- Racked and stacked routers, switches, servers, UPS units and a Dell PowerStore array; helped configure BGP routing
- Performed initial Dell PowerStore setup, including management ports; built a NAS server with SMB shares and configured Dell CAVA antivirus scanning
- Build and troubleshoot virtual machines and networks in VMware vSphere/vCenter and Proxmox for the campus cyber range; manage lab configurations in GitLab and deploy services with Kubernetes
- Helped build the college's locally hosted Capture-the-Flag platform and created many of its challenges so students can learn CTFs and practice for competitions

Office Clerk / Peer Mentor

May 2020 – Aug 2024

St. Philip's College, San Antonio, TX

- Served as first point of contact for students, staff and visitors: answered questions, explained processes and resolved complaints
- Managed office schedules, calendars and appointments; mentored peers with F.R.E.E. and co-hosted campus events

COMPETITIONS & LEADERSHIP

- **National Cyber League (3 seasons):** Fall 2025 Team Game, 96th of 4,214 (98th percentile) and 15th nationally in Scanning & Reconnaissance with a perfect score. Spring 2026 Individual Game, 456th of 7,010 (94th percentile), 99th percentile in Cryptography and Network Traffic Analysis. Fall 2025 Individual Game, 93rd percentile. Verify: cyberskyline.com/report/U7A9L6475DED
- **Team Captain, 2026 HSI Battle of the Brains:** led a team pitching an AI product (NETA); ran team meetings on Zoom and Slack
- **NCAE Cyber Games** competitor; **Cyber Tigers** member; volunteer for Cyber Fiesta and Cyber Awareness Month

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Applied Technology, Cybersecurity – St. Philip's College, GPA 3.69

Expected Dec 2026

AAS, Information Technology Cybersecurity – St. Philip's College, GPA 3.5

Dec 2024

Associate, Web and Mobile Development – St. Philip's College, GPA 3.5

May 2023

CompTIA Security+ (in progress, exam November 2026)

Awards: Level 1 Certificate, Web and Mobile Developer; Occupational Skills Awards in IT Specialist, CompTIA Security Certification Preparation, Android Application Developer, Web Designer Apprentice I & II